

Numbers That Aren't Quantities

Topic 1.2 · TODAY'S PROBLEM

A school newspaper surveyed six students for a story about getting to school. Part of the data table is shown.

Two reporters disagree about the numbers in it. **Maya:** “Zip code and Rating are both quantitative — they’re numbers, so we can average them.” **Jordan:** “They’re both categorical. Numbers can be labels.”

Getting-to-school survey (six students)

Student	Lunch period	Zip code	Commute (min)
Aiden	A	01902	12
Bea	B	01905	35
Cruz	A	01902	8
Dev	C	01904	22
Elise	B	01905	41
Fiona	A	01901	15

FIRST TAKE (5 min, on your sheet)

Is a zip code a quantitative variable? One sentence: yes or no, and the reason you'd give Maya.

- DOK 1** (a) Who are the individuals in this data set, and what are the four variables?
- DOK 2** (b) Classify each of the four variables as categorical or quantitative. For each quantitative variable, state its unit.
- DOK 3** (c) Decide who is right about **Zip code** and who is right about **Rating**, using the definition of a quantitative variable in each case. Then name one specific calculation a reader would find meaningless if Maya's classification were used for Zip code, and explain why it is meaningless.

Video + follow-along: [u1_lesson2_live.html](https://www.illustrativemathematics.org/HS/index.html) (scan the code)

Finish (a)–(c) after the video. Turn in your sheet.

